

PRACTITIONER QUICK REFERENCE

AI in Project & Program Management

For Project Managers · Program Managers · Portfolio Managers · Scrum Masters · Release Managers

20+

Use Cases

40+

Prompts

5

Tool Ecosystems

4–6 hrs

Saved/Week

FROM THE FIELD

"Managing a \$65M+ portfolio across 12 enterprise clients taught me that the bottleneck was never the work — it was the synthesis. AI changed that. The judgment and relationships are still mine. The synthesis runs in minutes now, not hours."

— Senior Delivery Leader, Enterprise Insurance & Financial Services

01 · WHERE AI FITS — 6 PM DELIVERY DOMAINS

Domain	AI Does This	Key Tools
Planning & Work Breakdown	WBS generation, epic decomposition, story writing, effort estimation from scope descriptions	All AI Assistants · Jira AI · Copilot in Excel
Budget & Cost Tracking	Variance narratives, EAC/ETC models, burn rate summaries, spreadsheet formula automation	Copilot in Excel · Power BI · Claude
Status Reporting	RAG summaries from sprint data, board narratives, stakeholder emails, executive slide content	Copilot in Word/PPT · Claude · Jira AI
Risk & RAID Management	RAID extraction from transcripts, risk pre-mortems, mitigation drafts, stress-testing plans	Claude · Meeting AI tools · Jira AI
Team & Meeting Intelligence	Transcription, action extraction, blocker flagging, follow-up drafts, coaching frameworks	Copilot for Teams · Fireflies.ai · Otter.ai
Agile & Release Mgmt	PI Planning prep, retro synthesis, release checklists, backlog grooming, Go/No-Go docs	Jira AI · Miro AI · Linear AI · Claude

02 · CORE PROMPT PATTERNS

Scenario: Status Report from Sprint Data

PROMPT

Create a weekly status report from this sprint data:
Sprint 12 | Velocity: 34 (planned 40) Completed: [list]
| Blocked: [issue] Format: RAG status + 3
accomplishments + risks + next week + decisions needed.
Audience: Sponsor.

OUTPUT

Formatted status report with RAG status, bullets, and escalation flags in ~90 seconds. Ready to email or paste to Confluence.

Scenario: Budget Variance Narrative

PROMPT

Write a 3-paragraph executive narrative for a steering committee: Budget: \$4.2M | Spend M5: \$1.95M Planned: \$1.72M | Variance: +\$230K (13.4%) Root cause: Extended UAT + contractor extension. Tone: Professional, confident, factual.

OUTPUT

Board-ready 3-paragraph narrative stating variance, explaining causes with context, and describing corrective actions and revised forecast.

Scenario: RAID Log from Meeting Transcript

PROMPT

Extract a RAID log from this transcript: Categories: Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies For each: ID | Description | Owner | Impact (H/M/L) | Due Date | Status [Paste transcript here]

OUTPUT

Structured RAID log with all items categorized, owned, and prioritized. 60-min meeting transcript processed in under 3 minutes.

Scenario: Risk Pre-Mortem**PROMPT**

Assume this project failed at completion. What went wrong? Project: [describe scope, timeline, team]
Identify 8 risks a typical PM would overlook. For each: description, why it is missed, specific mitigation, leading indicator.

OUTPUT

8 specific overlooked risks with actionable mitigations.
Use as input for your next risk workshop or RAID session.

03 · AI TOOL STACK — START WITH WHAT YOU HAVE

Microsoft 365 Copilot	Office AI	Status in Word, budgets in Excel, slides in PPT, email in Outlook, summaries in Teams	M365 add-on
Claude (Anthropic)	AI Assistant	Long docs, WBS generation, RFP drafting, RAID synthesis, risk pre-mortems, narratives	Free / Pro tier
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	AI Assistant	Advanced data analysis, CSV uploads, code automation, broad PM task coverage	Free / Plus tier
Atlassian Intelligence	PM Tooling	Summarize epics, generate child issues, search Confluence/Jira, draft release notes	Premium/Enterprise
Fireflies.ai / Otter.ai	Meeting AI	Auto-transcribe meetings, extract action items, search meeting history, follow-up emails	Free / Pro tier
Power BI + Copilot	Analytics AI	Natural language queries on project data, auto-generate visual reports, anomaly explanation	M365/Fabric
Miro AI	Collab AI	Cluster retro stickies, generate mind maps, summarize whiteboard sessions	Included in Miro
ServiceNow Now Assist	ITSM AI	Summarize incidents, draft change requests, suggest knowledge articles	ServiceNow add-on

04 · AI LEARNING PATHS BY ROLE

Role	Start Here (Free)	Next Step	Strategic / Advanced
Project Manager	PMI GenAI for PMs micro-credential (~6 hrs, paid exam) M365 Copilot Adoption content (adoption.microsoft.com)	Anthropic Academy — Claude for Work (~4 hrs) Microsoft AI-900 learning path (~8 hrs)	PMI AI+ Micro-Credential (PDUs) MIT Sloan AI Strategy (online, ~30 hrs)
Program & Portfolio Mgr	Google GenAI Learning Path — Cloud Skills Boost (~10 hrs, free)	AWS AI Practitioner badge C01 (\$150 exam) Google Cloud Digital Leader (\$200 exam)	MIT Sloan AI Strategy Anthropic: Responsible AI in Enterprise (governance focus)
Scrum Master	Anthropic + DeepLearning.AI: Prompt Engineering for PMs (~10 hrs, free)	Google PMs (PMP) badge in Vertex AI (free badge) Google: Responsible AI Practices (free)	Microsoft: GitHub Copilot for Delivery Teams AWS GenAI Essentials (~6 hrs, free)
Release Manager	Google GenAI Learning Path (~10 hrs, free) Anthropic Academy (free)	AWS GenAI Essentials + Responsible AI on AWS (~6 hrs) Microsoft AI-900 learning path (~8 hrs)	AWS AI Practitioner AIF-C01 (\$150) GitHub Copilot for DevOps Teams (Microsoft)

Recommended sequence for any role: (1) Google GenAI Path — free foundations, ~10 hrs. (2) Anthropic Prompt Engineering for PMs — highest daily ROI, ~3 hrs, free. (3) Apply to your stack: M365 Copilot Adoption or Anthropic Academy. (4) Platform cert: AI-900 (Azure/M365) or AWS AI Practitioner (AIF-C01). (5) Strategic depth: PMI AI+ Badge or MIT Sloan AI Strategy.

All free learning paths require no payment. Paid exam costs listed for reference only. PMI credential holders: every AI course listed qualifies for PDUs toward PMP, PgMP, PfMP, or PMI-ACP renewal.

Provider	Free Entry Point	Paid Credential	Best For
Microsoft	AI-900 path at learn.microsoft.com (~8 hrs) M365 Copilot Adoption (adoption.microsoft.com)	AI-900 exam (~\$165) AI-102 Engineer (~\$165)	M365 / Azure environments
Google	GenAI Learning Path — Cloud Skills Boost (~10 hrs) Responsible AI Practices (free badge)	Cloud Digital Leader (~\$200)	All roles — best free foundations

AWS	GenAI Essentials on AWS Skill Builder (~6 hrs) Responsible AI on AWS (free)	AI Practitioner AIF-C01 (~\$150)	AWS-environment PMs
Anthropic	Anthropic Academy (anthropic.com/academy) Prompt Engineering for PMs via DeepLearning.AI (~3 hrs)	No paid cert — practical focus	Claude users · responsible AI focus
PMI	GenAI for PMs micro-credential path (pmi.org)	PMI AI+ Badge (PDUs toward renewal)	PM / PgMP / PfMP holders

05 · PM AI MATURITY MODEL — WHERE ARE YOU TODAY?

Level	Stage	What It Looks Like	Your Next Move
1	AI-Aware	Know tools exist. Tried 1–2 things. No regular use.	Pick one workflow. Run one prompt this week.
2	AI-Experimenting	Occasional use. No saved prompts. Sporadic value.	Save 3 prompts that worked. Use twice/week until habit.
3 ★	AI-Practicing (Target)	AI in 2–4 workflows. Prompt library exists. 3–5 hrs saved/week.	Extend to new domain. Start influencing teammates.
4	AI-Integrating	AI across the delivery lifecycle. Coaching others. Measuring impact.	Formalize team coaching plan. Publish one internal insight.
5	AI-Leading	Defining AI strategy. Governing responsible use. Thought leadership.	Translate internal experience into external positioning.

06 · 90-DAY ACTIVATION PLAN

Phase	Timing	Personal Actions	Team Actions
Foundation	Days 1–14	Set up Claude/ChatGPT/Copilot. Pick one workflow (status reports, RAID log, meeting follow-up, executive narrative, WBS decomposition, meeting action items, program slippage rate, net time saved per PM).	Big Brother AI-generated prompts. Set team meeting agendas. Identify 2 paths.
Expand	Days 15–30	Add RAID extraction and meeting follow-up workflows. Try Copilot for Teams.	Run Excel formulae to track key save measures. Improve this month. Start to influence others.
Systematize	Days 31–60	Add AI content to one client or executive deliverable. Begin a free AI certification (Google, Coursera, AWS) and 2 more workflows, peer.	AI certification (Google, Coursera, AWS) and 2 more workflows, peer.
Lead	Days 61–90	Assess maturity level using Section 05 model. Quantify impact. Publish team maturity level. OKR cycle. Plan next.	Assess team maturity level. OKR cycle. Plan next.

07 · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE — OUTCOME BENCHMARKS

Metric	Before AI	With AI Practice	Enabler
Weekly status report	3–4 hrs manual drafting	< 30 minutes	Claude / Copilot in Word + prompt template
RAID log currency	End of sprint, often incomplete	Real-time via meeting AI	Fireflies.ai or Otter.ai + RAID prompt
Executive narrative	2–3 hrs drafting and revision	20 minutes	Claude with variance data pasted in
WBS decomposition	1–2 days in workshops	2–3 hours	Claude + SOW as context input
Meeting action items	30–45 min post-meeting admin	5 min review of AI output	Copilot for Teams or Fireflies.ai
Program slippage rate	~22% average across programs	< 8% with AI risk monitoring	AI risk pre-mortem + proactive RAID management
Net time saved per PM	0 hrs	4–6 hrs / week	Consistent prompt library + 3+ workflows embedded

"The PMs who get the most from AI treat it like a capable junior analyst — not a magic oracle. Give it context. Structure the ask. Review the output. Apply your judgment. When you operate that way, AI makes you faster, more thorough, and more creative. The technology is genuinely transformative. The professional judgment about how to use it is still entirely yours."